Select Board Meeting

Minutes

September 15, 2026

Call to Order

Ricky called the Select Board (SB) Meeting to order at the Town Hall at 5:31 PM with the Pledge of Allegiance.
SB members present: Ricky Emery, Brian Fortier, and Tracie Antolin.
Also present: Anna Maxwell (Rec. Director), Whit Lucy (Assistant Fire Chief), William "Bill" Flynn (Safety Officer), Cynthia Eaton (Animal Control Officer), Richard "Dicky" Perreault, Patty Drain (Administrative Assistant), Jennifer Noble, Roland Blake, Chad Pine, Robin Foster, Joe & Terry Egan, Dan & Carole Kuntz, Vinny Lanovara, Austin, Tom Dugas, Dustin Rhoda, Barbara Moulton, Theresa Nunan, Deb Tait, Lisa Saffer, Andy Buck, Steve Nutting, Thai Lovering, Jonna Carter, Bob Wallstrom, and others that did not sign in or whose signatures were illegible.

Ricky announced his intent to deviate from the agenda.

Moratorium – Ricky moved to enter "5,000" into the blank for square footage on Section 3: A:2 of the Moratorium:Ordinance to Establish a Temporary Moratorium on Data Centers. Tracie seconded; the motion carried, 3-0. He explained that this would prohibit data centers greater than 5,000 sq. ft. Two public meetings were announced for the ordinance. Both meetings will take place at the Rec Center at 6:00 PM.

- Informational Meeting: Tuesday, September 22
- Public Hearing: Tuesday, October 13

Minutes

Ricky motioned to approve the Minutes of the August 24, 2026, Select Board Workshop: Elected Officials/Planning Board. Brian seconded; the motion carried, 3-0.
Ricky moved to approve the Minutes of the August 25, 2026, Select Board Executive Session (5 PM). Tracie seconded; the motion carried, 3-0.
Ricky moved to approve the Minutes of the August 25, 2026, Select Board Executive Session (6 PM). Brian seconded; the motion carried, 3-0.
Ricky moved to approve the Minutes of the September 1, 2026, Select Board Meeting. Tracie seconded; the motion carried, 3-0.
Ricky moved to approve the Minutes of the September 2, 2026, Select Board Executive Session. Brian seconded; the motion carried, 3-0.
Ricky moved to approve the minutes of the September 10, 2026, Select Board Workshop: Facilitator. Tracie seconded; the motion carried, 3-0.

Approve Payroll & A/P's - The SB signed and approved.

ADA Update - None

Department Heads Update

Fire Chief, Richard "Dicky" Perreault – reported a golf cart accident, a medical assist, and Mutual Aid to Fryeburg (lift assist) and Center Conway, NH (station coverage). He reported the following actions:

- Continued efforts toward hazard vulnerability preparedness
- Air tanks have been returned and installed on the air system
- Attended a meeting with the MWV Mutual Aid Assoc.
- Submitted a report for the water source for ABS Properties LLC
- Serviced extrication tools
- Reviewed hose test results
- Scheduled truck and furnace repairs
- Saturday training with Denmark and CMP
- Saturday training with Center Conway Fire – Med Flight

Health Officer, Bill Flynn – reported that a representative from ECOMAINE has offered to speak with residents about the Extended Producer Responsibility initiative and provide a detailed overview of the program and its potential benefits if the Town chooses to participate. Bill also noted that, in response to interest expressed by those in attendance, he will request that a community composting class be offered to residents.

Code Enforcement Officer, Michael Wentworth – reported issuing two building permits and two occupancy permits. He announced that he has completed 5 of the 6 required CEO certifications.

Animal Control Officer, Cindy Eaton - reported responding to a call about a loose animal on River Road and noted the completion of FOAA training.

Rec Director, Anna Maxwell - reported the following:

- Soccer has begun, with four teams participating in grades K–6.
- The After-school Program is now in its third week, which she described as "absolutely incredible."
- Chinese Auction fundraiser generated $1,277. The funds will assist families who cannot afford the $10 daily fee and to support the development of an outdoor natural scape in the wooded area, inspired by suggestions from children in the program.
- The batting cages are nearing completion, with installation of the artificial turf pending.
- Docks and porta-potties removal for the season.
- The facility's updated keypad entry system has been installed. Individuals with up-to-date accounts have received their new key codes. Those with unpaid or expired memberships are encouraged to contact the Recreation Director to update payment information if they want to receive a key code.
- A Trunk or Treat and a family-friendly, not-so-scary haunted playground is planned for Halloween.

School Board, Terry Egan - reported that an ad hoc committee was created to review the necessity of the Brownfield–Denmark Elementary School. The committee includes current School Board members, representatives from Brownfield and Denmark, and school administrators. Enrollment currently stands at 70 students in grades K–4. The committee has scheduled biweekly meetings from now through December. Meetings will be held at the school on Mondays from 3:00 – 4:30 p.m. The public is welcome to attend;

however, there will be no public comment. Meeting dates are posted on both the MSAD 72 website and the Town's website. The committee will review current and projected enrollment, assess the financial impacts of maintaining the school versus consolidating students into Molly Ockett or New Suncook, and evaluate operational factors. Once data is received, recommendations will be presented to the School Board.

Committee/ Board Updates

Town Garden - Barbara announced a meet-up on Saturday.

Public Safety Building - The committee is still awaiting the return of the contract submitted to Haley Ward.

Grant - Vinny announced that a meeting is scheduled for Wednesday and reported that the committee is currently down three members, including Tim Lyons, who recently resigned, and Amanda and {Jayden}, who have not attended committee meetings thus far.

Agenda Item

Dunn Memorial Park - Small Conversion - Tabled until Doug Beck returns from vacation.
{Doug is an employee of the Maine Department of Agriculture, Conservation, and Forestry; Bureau of Parks and Land.}

Warming Center - Ricky revisited the discussion of opening a warming center due to rising heating costs. Dicky stated that his oversight as Fire Chief would be limited to daytime hours, while Anna is present. He also pointed out that the Red Cross evaluated the facility and that it is not equipped for overnight use. He also expressed concerns that operating a warming center overnight makes it a shelter and would create shelter-related responsibilities and potential General Assistance obligations for the Town, and if the shelter were to close, the Town could be responsible for assisting occupants with alternative accommodations regardless of their community of origin. The Chief highlighted the following numbers, 211 and 988, for people to call if they need assistance.
Ricky stated that he would like to have a discussion with EMA Director Allison Hill, noting that the State is promoting such initiatives.
Tracie reported that a review of prior records showed that most attendees arrived and remained at the facility between 5:00 p.m. and 9:00 p.m. She suggested that volunteers could assist during those hours and additionally proposed a collaborative effort between the Recreation Department and the Kindness Committee.

Correspondence Folder Items

Surveillance Recording Access & Download Policy - Tracie requested to table the proposed policy for further review.

BCC Rental Rules and Regulations for Use Policy - Ricky moved to approve the BCC Rental Rules and Regulations for Use Policy. Tracie seconded; the motion carried, 3-0.

Rec/Community Center Access Policy - Tracie requested to table the proposed policy for further review.

Code Enforcement Fee Schedule Update - Ricky moved to accept the updated Code Enforcement Fee Schedule with the addition of, After-the-Fact Permits are charged the required fee, plus an additional ***"100"*** % of required fees. Brian seconded; the motion carried, 3-0. The amount of 100 was written into the document by the Chairman.

Committee Resignations and Requests to Join - Ricky noted that Tim Lyons has resigned from the Grant Committee, leaving an even number of members, and asked Patty to notify the chair of that committee that if all members are present, the chair should abstain from voting while there is an even number attending.

The board was in receipt of two requests to join the Ordinance Review Committee. Ricky motioned to appoint Jenn Noble and Dustin Rhoda to the Ordinance Review Committee. Brian seconded; the motion carried, 3-0.

Road Closures - Ricky noted that the board reviews road closures every ten years and that an updated list of road closures will be placed on the warrant next year.

Letter of Appreciation - Ricky read a postcard received from a camper who thanked the Town for providing the opportunity to attend Camp Susan Curtis and expressed appreciation for the experience.

Ricky announced the following meetings:

- Informational Meeting on an Ordinance to Establish a Temporary Moratorium on Data Centers on Tuesday, September 22, at 6 PM
- Public Hearing on the General Assistance Ordinance on Tuesday, October 6, at 5:30 PM
- Public Hearing on an Ordinance to Establish a Temporary Moratorium on Data Centers on Tuesday, October 13, at 6 PM.

Communication Committee - Tracie suggested dissolving the Communication Committee. Vinny, a member of the committee, noted that its original purpose was to assist residents in receiving updates through the Town's new website. He further stated that the committee had experienced difficulty achieving a quorum for meetings. Ricky motioned to dissolve the Communication Committee. Brian seconded; the motion carried, 3-0.

Public Comment

Vinny noted that a member from the Grant Committee will be away for the winter. He inquired whether the member could attend via Zoom or other digital means and, if so, he wondered if they would maintain their voting privileges. The board agreed that attending through the suggested means and voting was acceptable. Ricky emphasized that, as an advisory committee to the SB, in the end, they bring their recommendations to them for their review.

Terry thanked Barbara, Carol, Dan, and the rest of the Garden Committee for their efforts on the Town flower beds. She also shared some feedback with Anna, saying that a young boy who was supposed to get on the bus at BDS and go to the other program said, "I want to get on the bus for the Rec Program because that's where I want to be." A parent also said that she went to pick her kids up from the Rec, and they didn't want to leave and had a meltdown. Terry told Anna, "…you're doing something right, keep it up!"

Tom suggested promoting Brownfield as an over-60, retirement-friendly community to stabilize taxes. He proposed a 10% property tax discount to retain an elderly population in an effort to limit homes being sold to

younger families with children, which would increase school enrollment and necessitate school expansion. He referenced the Towns of Windham and Gorham, which are experiencing tax base pressures due to the construction of new schools and low-income housing.
Tracie stated that when the auditor was here, he had mentioned inviting low-income 55-and-up communities as a strategy to help the tax base.
Carol asked whether the proposed small conversion had been decided upon. Ricky stated that Doug had suggested the small conversion as the initial step and that the Town is still awaiting the necessary language from him before proceeding.
Tracie explained that the Town currently does not have deeded access to the park {because existing buildings do not align with the original plans}. She noted that the proposed small conversion would provide the Town with the required access.
Further discussion followed regarding compliance concerns. Ricky stated that Doug had identified the Town Hall, constructed in 1993, as the most significant compliance issue. He noted, however, that no inspection records in the Town's possession indicate that the property was ever found to be out of compliance. He also stated that when Catherine Dufault inspected the wooden playground the previous year, no compliance concerns were identified. Ricky further commented that compliance issues are not prohibitive to grant eligibility and observed that the same department raising the compliance concerns would also be responsible for reviewing the Town's grant application. He added that a small conversion process can take up to three years to complete.
The board spoke briefly of utilizing a survey to gauge Town interest in moving ahead with Dunn Memorial Park.

Ricky motioned to close the SB meeting at 6:47 PM. Tracie seconded. The motion carried, 3-0.

Ricky Emery, Chair | Brian Fortier | Tracie Antolin

Date: 10-6-2026

** Items contained in { } are not part of the Minutes and are added for clarification or for informational purposes only.*